

Fee Regulation for Private Higher Education Institutions

— Regulation Document

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This regulation document gives effect to Fee Regulation for Private Higher Education Institutions and covers the purposes, responsibilities and operating expectations associated with Fee Regulation. It should be read alongside supporting guidance and any subsequent circulars.

Background and Scope

Stakeholders across Higher Education Department have emphasised the importance of Fee Regulation as a foundation for credible, well-governed higher education. The present regulation document responds to that expectation by setting out clear, practical direction.

Following sustained engagement with universities, colleges and sector bodies, Higher Education Department has prepared this regulation document to give effect to Fee Regulation, Private Institutions. It builds on earlier guidance while updating expectations to reflect current conditions.

Purpose and Intent

This regulation document is intended to translate the objectives of Fee Regulation for Private Higher Education Institutions into actionable direction for institutions, officials and other stakeholders, ensuring that Fee Regulation is pursued in a structured and accountable manner.

By setting out the rationale, scope and operating expectations for Fee Regulation, the document aims to reduce ambiguity, support institutional planning and improve the quality of Private Institutions across the system.

Goals

In pursuing these objectives, Higher Education Department intends to create conditions in which institutions can deliver consistent, high-quality outcomes in respect of Fee Regulation, Private Institutions, Refund Policy, with clear lines of accountability.

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Coverage

This document covers all activities and stakeholders associated with Fee Regulation within institutions affiliated to Higher Education Department, together with arrangements for monitoring, review and reporting of outcomes.

The provisions apply to all universities and colleges under Higher Education Department. Sector partners, including employers and professional bodies, are expected to support implementation within their respective spheres.

Core Provisions

The document mandates periodic self-assessment against Fee Regulation, disclosure of material information to Higher Education Department, and corrective action where institutional performance falls short of the stated expectations.

Institutions are required to integrate Fee Regulation, Private Institutions into annual planning cycles, designate accountable officers, and maintain records demonstrating compliance with the expectations set out here.

Implementation Pathway

Implementation will proceed through phased institutional adoption, supported by professional development, shared guidance and a common reporting calendar established by Higher Education Department.

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Institutional Responsibilities

Higher Education Department provides policy direction, capacity support and performance oversight, while institutions translate the framework into operational practice and maintain day-to-day accountability.

Heads of institutions bear overall responsibility for embedding Fee Regulation, supported by designated coordinators, academic bodies and administrative units within each institution.

Monitoring Arrangements

Monitoring covers both compliance and quality, combining documented evidence with stakeholder feedback to build a complete picture of institutional performance over time.

Closing Note

This document is designed to evolve with institutional experience. Feedback from stakeholders will shape refinements, ensuring that the framework remains practical, proportionate and fit for purpose.